

RIVER

2024



CLAUDIO GOBBER ART

www.claudiogobberart.com

Preface

In the heart of Trentino, in northern Italy, where the Dolomites grace the landscape with their timeless beauty, Claudio Gobber has embarked on a transformative artistic journey titled "River 2024". The essence of this project lies in the untold stories etched into pieces of wood collected from the riverbanks of small, enchanting rivers that wind through the region. Inspired by the bold aesthetics of Pop Art and the intellectual exploration of Cubism, this intriguing collection of sculptures and paintings delves into transformational powers of art and nature.

Within these pages, you will discover a collection that showcases Gobber's unique vision and exceptional talent. Using vibrant energy and multifaceted perspectives, these sculptures and paintings embody the artist's exploration of the creative power held in the rivers of his homeland. Through this collection viewers are invited to reflect on the results of natural destruction, sustainability and consumption and how we perceive value in beauty in the objects around us.

Combining elements of Pop Art and Cubism, he presents a body of work that is both visually striking and conceptually profound, while revitalising the beauty in forgotten materials.

Through his art, the artist aims to engage viewers in a continuous dialogue, exploring a diverse range of subjects that are as dynamic and transformative as the world we inhabit.

Introduction

Natural Evolution

This collection of sculptures celebrates one of the core materials of the natural and wild environment of the mountain landscape. The wooden forms that Gobber has created have their origins woven into the life of the Trentino ecosystem. These humble remnants of nature have borne witness to the passage of time, been shaped by the rolling currents and the caress of water over many years. Recent shifts in climate, possibly attributed to global warming, have brought about storms and heavy rains, causing an influx of fallen trees into the rivers. In the dance between the river, sunlight, and the myriad of small creatures, these once proud trees metamorphose into unique shapes and forms, each carrying a tale of resilience.

Positive Transformation

"River" is a testament to the artist's philosophy of adapting to change and turning challenges into positive memories. Gobber's intention is to repurpose the old and broken, turning discarded remnants into precious works of art. Each sculpture is a celebration of resilience, capturing the spirit of transformation and the beauty that emerges from life's unpredictable currents.

The repurpose and renewal of these objects reflects nature's true sustainable nature. We can witness everyday natural objects that serve multiple purposes and take on various forms during their cycle through life and death on this earth.

Purpose

Through "River 2024," Claudio Gobber invites viewers to appreciate the beauty in adaptation and the alchemy that occurs when nature, time, and artistic vision converge. These sculptures serve as reminders that even in the face of upheaval, there is an opportunity to create something enduring and meaningful.

Artistic Process

Step into the emotional timeline Gobber meticulously gathered these weathered pieces of wood and transported them to his studio in Trento, in North East Italy. Here, the artist delicately cleaned, sanded, and sculpted the wood with precision, guided by his artistic vision. Using his vibrant acrylic colours, he breathed new life into these forgotten fragments, transforming them into a collection of 12 sculptures.

Sculptural Forms

The sculptures vary in size, ranging from 25 cm to 100 cm, each mounted on a solid cement base that complements and grounds them. These bases not only provide stability but also symbolise the strength derived from adapting to changing circumstances.

Paintings

As an extension of the artistic process, Gobber added further value to the original forms by examining details of the three dimensional sculptures. By creating paintings of sculptures he has increased the value to the original pieces of driftwood. What emerges is an abstract snapshot telling a new story. The artist has found a way to communicate his personal view of these new sculptures. With the paintings he holds the audience's gaze on one aspect and allows them to enter into a space that may have just been a fleeting glance when faced with the physical sculptures.

Aspects of River

Sculptures

1. The Pig (cover)
2. Adam & Eve
3. Gina
4. Beheaded Dragon
5. Bonnie & Clyde
6. Meteorite
7. Warm Hand
8. Old Man
9. Enrosadira Velata
10. Bonsai
11. Tree House
12. Stonehenge
13. Le Tre Grazie Cesse

Paintings

1. The Pig
2. Gina
3. Beheaded Dragon 1
4. Bonnie & Clyde
5. Meteorite
6. Warm Hand 1
7. Old Man
8. Enrosadira Velata
9. Bonsai
10. Tree House
11. Beheaded Dragon 2
12. Warm Hand 2



ADAM & EVE



GINA



BEHEADED DRAGON



BONNIE & CLYDE



METEORITE



WARM HAND



OLD MAN



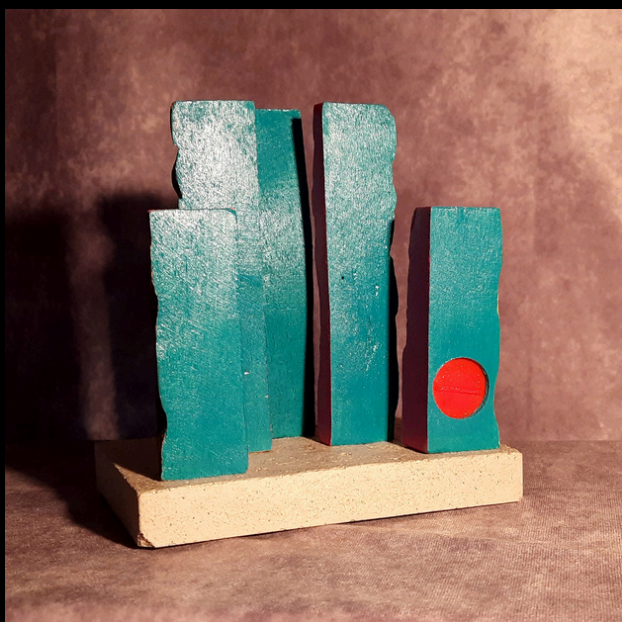
ENROSADIRA VELATA



BONSAI



TREE HOUSE



STONEHENGE



LE TRE GRAZIE CESSÉ



THE PIG



GINA



BEHEADED DRAGON 1



BONNIE & CLYDE



METEORITE



WARM HAND 1



OLD MAN



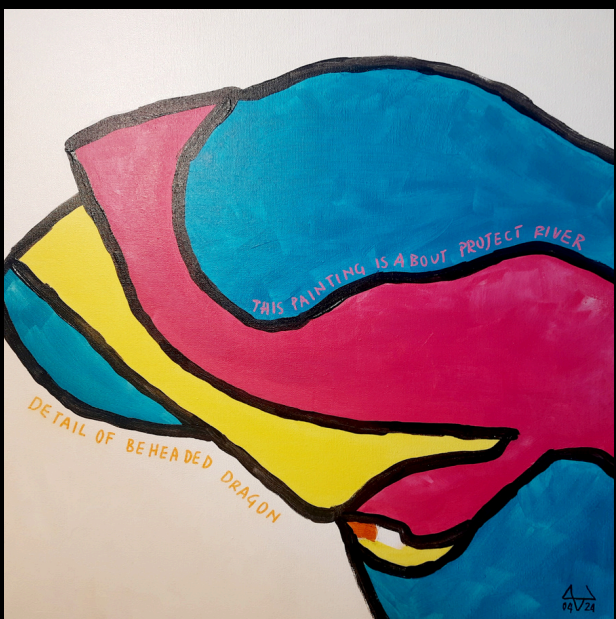
ENROSADIRA VELATA



BONSAI



TREE HOUSE



BEHEADED DRAGON 2



WARM HAND 2

River's Melody

Nature's Art Unveiled

In the river's flow, where time's currents glide,
Nature and art, entwined in stride.
"River," a canvas divine,
Where nature's elements with art combine.

From the river's banks, where wood does rest,
Bearing the marks of time's gentle test.
Weathered and worn, by rain and sun's kiss,
Each piece a story, a tale of bliss.

Collected by hands that honor the earth,
Wood finds new purpose, a rebirth.
In the artist's care, it begins to sing,
Nature's melody, in every ring.

Bathed in sunlight's golden hue,
Transformed by raindrops, fresh and new.
Each grain, a witness to time's embrace,
Nature's artistry, in every trace.

In the artist's hands, wood comes alive,
Sculpted and shaped, where dreams revive.
With every stroke, a story's told,
Nature's beauty, in art's stronghold.

"River" whispers secrets of old,
Where art and nature's tale is told.
In wood and water, sun and rain,
Eternal beauty, in nature's refrain.

Biography



Born in Trentino in 1979, Claudio Gobber grew up in the magnificent valleys of Primiero and Vanoi. Inspired by the work of Trentino and South Tyrolean artists from a young age, including Riccardo Schweizer, Simone Turra, and Giuliano Orsingher. He recognises himself as a sculptor, painter, photographer, and designer with a passion for new technologies.

While art has always been his Yin, business was his Yang. After a period of studying in Milan, where he obtained a bachelor's degree and a master's degree in Advertising, he moved to London, where he lived for 10 years. During his time in the city he was immersed in the world of photography, practicing the techniques his grandfather taught him as a young boy. This modern adventure was intersected by regular sessions in the mountain studio where he continued to paint and sculpt. Here Gobber balanced the frenzy of London by embracing the local woods that dominate the landscape near his family home.

After time in Switzerland and Spain, Gobber returned to Trentino where he continued to develop his paintings producing numerous acrylic works, and at this time, he developed an inclination towards creating clay sculptures. Indeed his art is strongly influenced by many different genres including digital works and NFTs emerging from the Crypto movement, and Gobber has a particular interest in the use of Generative Art software and VR platforms. He is fascinated with how physical art can be enhanced and re-interpreted in a digital space.

His artistic journey has encompassed both traditional techniques and digital experimentation, fuelled by curiosity. He aims to push the boundaries of his creativity, producing aesthetically positive and conceptually stimulating works. His intention is not to dictate beliefs, but rather to cultivate awareness of these crucial dialogues and inspire individuals to form their own considered viewpoints. Encouraging the audience to draw upon the wealth of knowledge at their disposal, to facilitate the development of meaningful and substantiated perspectives. This is as true for future generations as for current audiences, with his art serving as an anthropological time capsule for this rapidly changing society.

His art has been exhibited in various national and international shows, and his work has been well received by diverse audiences. He continues to nurture his passion for art and seek new ways to express his creativity.

Further Information

Art:

This project is comprised of 12 individual sculptures and 12 paintings

The sculptures are made from driftwood native to the Trentino region, cement and acrylic paint,

All paintings are made on canvas measuring 50cm x 50cm, using acrylic.

Valuations details:

General artist valuation and critique issued by Vittorio Sgarbi 2023 "Annuario internazionale d'Arte contemporanea".

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